The Guardian

one stop english

How to quit fast fashion: 'Sometimes we don't need retail therapy, we need actual therapy'

Level 3: Elementary – Teacher's notes

Article summary: The article describes how four different people have quit fast fashion and encourages the reader to follow in their footsteps.

Time: 60 minutes

Skills: Reading, Speaking, Writing

Language focus: Vocabulary (collocations)

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. The purpose of this activity is to introduce the topic of fast fashion and to get students thinking about why the mass production of clothes is bad for the planet. Allow students to discuss and write any emerging language on the board.

2. Key words

a. Ask students to do the exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs or small groups. You can check understanding by eliciting different brands. Note that *salary* is a fixed amount of money paid periodically, while *wages* are usually paid by the hour. You can also point out that you can *order* in a restaurant or online on a website. You can elicit examples of different *hairstyles* or *styles of clothes* or *painting styles*.

Key:

1. *brain*
2. *brand*
3. *wage*
4. *joy*
5. *unsubscribe*
6. *style*
7. *browse*
8. *engage*
9. *environmental*
10. *order*

b. Ask students to complete the sentences individually and then share their questions and answers in pairs or small groups.

Key:

1. brand(s)
2. wages
3. browse; order
4. joy

3. Comprehension check

a. Ask students to work individually and find the part of the article where the information is mentioned. Then have students compare their answers in pairs or small groups before checking with the whole class.

Key:

1. *Maggie Zhou*
2. *Chris Cheers*
3. *Nico Idour*
4. *Wendy Syfret*
5. *Chris Cheers*
6. *Nico Idour*
7. *Maggie Zhou*
8. *Lauren Bravo*

4. Key language

a. Ask students to scan the text for the word pairs. Then have students shout out or type the answers in the chat. Ask students what parts of speech the words are (adjective + noun, except for 'shopping' and 'fashion', which are also nouns).

Key:

1. *fast fashion*
2. *retail therapy*
3. *shopping habits*
4. *fashion brands*
5. *environmental costs*
6. *international shipping*

b. Ask students to work together to complete the gaps. Then ask them to modify the sentences to make them true for them.

Key:

1. *shopping habits*
2. *international shipping*
3. *retail therapy*
4. *environmental costs*
5. *fashion brands*

5. Discussion

a. Allow students time to note down their ideas and encourage them to give reasons for their answer.

6. In your own words

a. The task could also be done as a homework task and students could then email each other (and you).

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